CEP PROJECT 1

THE GTA VI DATA BREACH

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WHY WAS THIS SUCH A BIG DEAL?

- Rockstar Games: The developer behind the Grand Theft Auto series.
- GTA VI: A highly anticipated game that was still in development.
- Confidential information: Unreleased footage and development materials were not intended for public release.
- Cybersecurity: The incident showed the risks companies face when unauthorized people access internal systems.

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WHAT HAPPENED?

Development footage leaked

Early GTA VI footage appeared online, showing parts of a game still in development.

Rockstar responds

The company publicly acknowledged the incident and said it would continue development as planned.

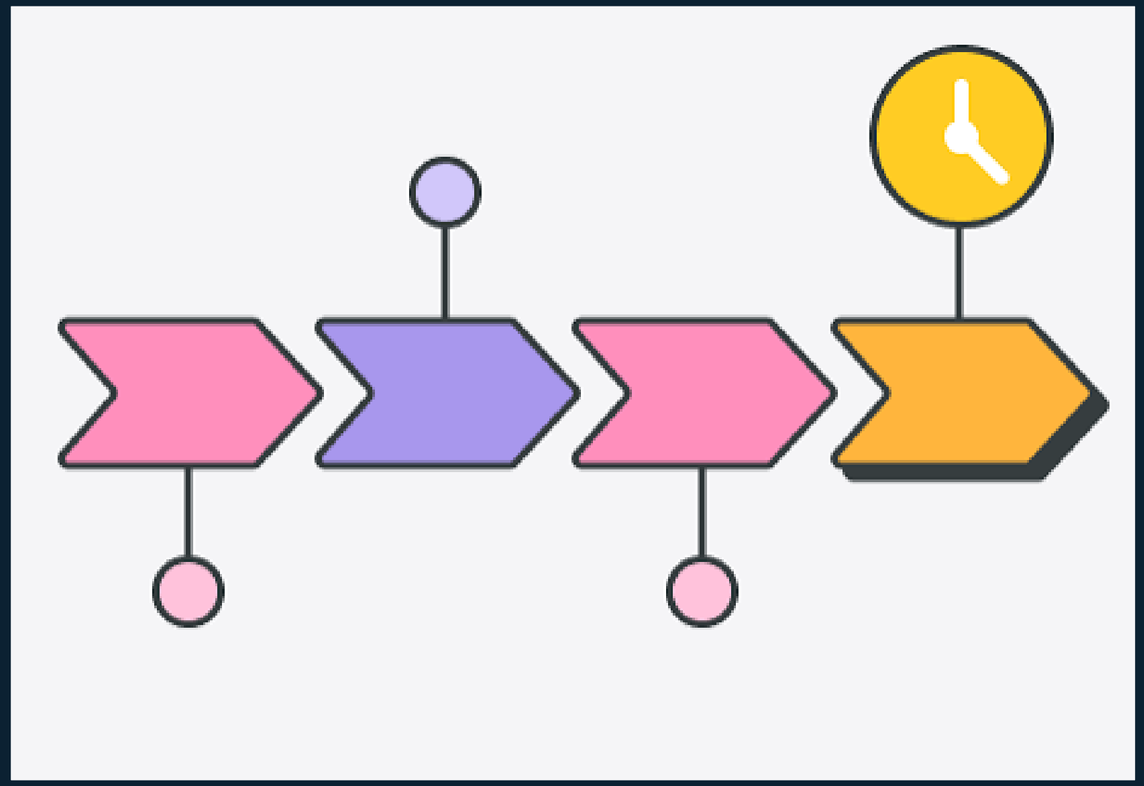


The Fall of GTA VI

TIMELINE OF THE INCIDENT

On **September 18, 2022,** a user known as '**CYBERLEEK**' posted **around 90 videos of unfinished GTA VI gameplay** on GTA Forums. The footage quickly spread across **social media** and became one of the **largest leaks in video-game history**

On **September 19, Rockstar Games** officially confirmed that an **unauthorized third party had accessed its systems** and taken **confidential information.** Rockstar expressed disappointment but stated that it did not expect the incident to interrupt its live services or have a long-term effect on game development."





THE MAIN QUESTION...

HOW DID THE ATTACK HAPPEN?

Rockstar officially described the incident as a network intrusion, meaning someone gained unauthorized access to its internal systems.

The attacker claimed that the files were obtained through Rockstar's internal Slack communication system. However, Rockstar did not publicly confirm the complete technical method used.

The incident was widely connected to social engineering. Social engineering involves manipulating an employee into providing access, approving a login request, or revealing information. This demonstrates that attackers do not always need to break complicated security software, they may target people instead."

VALUABLE INFORMATION CAME OUT....

WHAT INFORMATION WAS LEAKED?





The leak included approximately 90 videos showing an early, unfinished version of GTA VI. These videos revealed gameplay testing, character movement, locations, dialogue, weapons and other features that Rockstar had not announced publicly.

The attacker has also claimed to possess source code and additional internal material. However, the most clearly confirmed leaked information was the unfinished gameplay footage.

Although customer passwords and payment information were not reported as part of this incident, the stolen development material was still highly confidential and commercially valuable.

AS THEY SAY EVERY ACTION HAS ITS CONSEQUENCES

CONSEQUENCES OF THE ATTACK

The most immediate consequence was that Rockstar lost control over how GTA VI was introduced to the public. People saw unfinished test footage without understanding that bugs and incomplete graphics are normal during game development

Rockstar and its parent company, Take-Two Interactive, also had to request the removal of leaked material from websites and social-media platforms. Take-Two's shares initially fell during premarket trading, although some of those losses were later recovered.

The incident also created additional security work, possible financial costs and emotional pressure for the developers. However, Rockstar stated that its online services remained available and that it did not expect a long-term effect on its projects.



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TO PREVENT SIMILAR INCIDENTS, COMPANIES MUST COMBINE SECURE TECHNOLOGY WITH PROPERLY TRAINED EMPLOYEES.

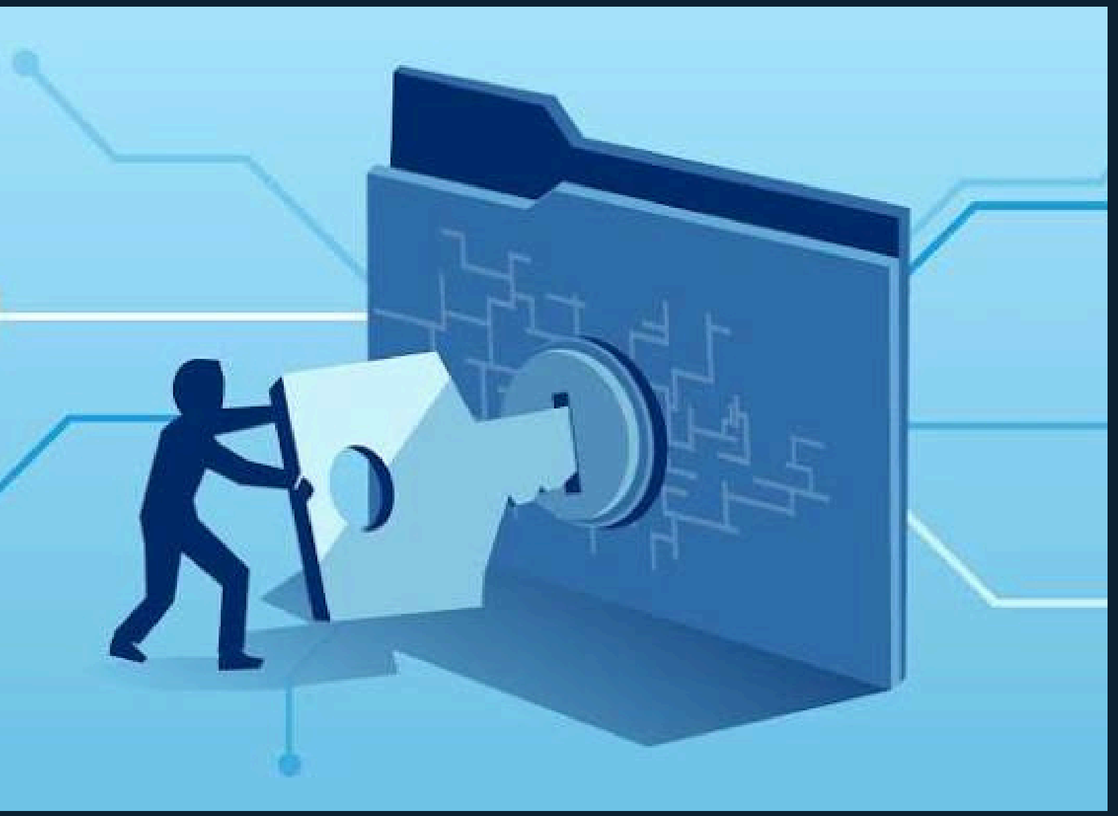
HOW COMPANIES CAN PREVENT SIMILAR ATTACKS

PROTECTION TO PREVENT TRAGEDIES

First, they should use strong multi-factor authentication so that a stolen password alone cannot provide access. They should also give employees access only to the information required for their jobs. This limits the amount of data an attacker can reach through one compromised account.

Companies should monitor unusual logins and large file downloads in real time. Sensitive source code and development files should be separated from communication platforms such as Slack whenever possible.

Finally, employees need regular training to recognize phishing, suspicious login requests and social-engineering attempts. Technology is important, but employees are also a major part of an organization’s defence



WHAT CAN COMPANIES LEARN?

Strengthen account security
Use multi-factor authentication and secure access methods.
Limit access
Give employees access only to the information they need.
Monitor for threats
Detect unusual account activity and investigate security alerts.
Prepare for incidents
Have a response plan to contain breaches and communicate clearly.

THANK YOU FOR YOUR ATTENTION